

Holiday & Monthly Reminders

How to set up and use this system.

What This System Does

This is a completely separate system from the New Member onboarding drip -- different audience (your own Clients list), different timing model (calendar dates, not "days since signup"). It handles two kinds of automated emails:

- **Holiday / Specific Date Reminders** -- emails everyone in your Clients list on (or before) a date you choose, every year automatically if you want it to repeat.
- **Monthly Client Reminder** -- a recurring email sent on the 1st of every month, except April and May are automatically skipped (so it effectively runs June through March).

1 Setup — Three Tabs

In your spreadsheet, you need exactly three tabs (tab names are case-sensitive):

Clients

Name	Email
------	-------

One row per client. Add or remove rows anytime -- no code changes needed.

Holiday_Dates

Date	Days Before	Recurring Annually	Subject	Body
------	-------------	--------------------	---------	------

One row per holiday or specific date you want to email about. Use {{name}} in Subject/Body for the client's first name.

Reminders_Config

Type	Subject	Body
Monthly	...	...

Exactly one row with Type = Monthly -- this is the content used for the recurring June-March email.

Then: paste the script into Extensions > Apps Script (opened from inside the Sheet), fill in SPREADSHEET_ID at the top, and run setup() once.

2 Understanding Days Before & Recurring Annually

These two columns give you full control over exactly when and how often each row fires:

Days Before	Meaning
0	Sends exactly ON that date.

1	Sends the day before (a 1-day-early reminder).
3, 7, etc.	Sends that many days earlier -- useful for "heads up" style messages.

Recurring Annually	Meaning
TRUE	Fires every year on that month/day (e.g. Christmas, birthdays, anniversaries) -- the year in the Date cell doesn't matter, only month and day are checked.
FALSE	Fires once, on that exact calendar date (year included) -- good for one-off deadlines or promotions that shouldn't repeat.

You can mix rows freely in the same sheet -- e.g. a "Christmas is coming!" row with Days Before = 3, alongside a "Merry Christmas!" row with Days Before = 0, both Recurring Annually = TRUE.

3 The Monthly Reminder

This fires automatically on the 1st of every month. Internally, it checks the current month against a skip list (April and May by default) -- if the month is in that list, nothing is sent and the function just logs that it skipped. Otherwise, it sends the Monthly-type message from Reminders_Config to everyone in Clients.

To change which months are skipped, edit the MONTHLY_SKIP_MONTHS constant near the top of the script (currently [4, 5] for April and May).

4 Testing Without Waiting

testHolidayReminder()

Edit rowToTest to the row number in Holiday_Dates you want to preview, then run it. This sends that row's email immediately to everyone in Clients, bypassing the date check entirely -- so you can check content and formatting without waiting for the actual date.

testMonthlyReminder()

Sends the Monthly reminder immediately, bypassing the month-skip check -- useful for previewing content even during April or May.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Cause & Fix
"Could not find a tab named..."	SPREADSHEET_ID at the top of the script is still the placeholder, or a tab name doesn't match exactly (case-sensitive). The error message lists the tabs that actually exist -- compare against that list.

"No row found in Reminders_Config for Type..."	Either the Type cell doesn't say exactly "Monthly", or you're accidentally pointed at a different Message_Config-style tab from another script that uses a different column structure.
Nothing sends on the expected date	Check Recurring Annually is set correctly, and that Days Before matches what you expect (0 = on the date, not before it).
Emails go out twice in one day	Shouldn't happen -- each Holiday_Dates row tracks its own "Last Sent Date" and skips itself if already sent today, even if the trigger runs more than once.

This system is fully independent from the New Member onboarding drip script -- separate tabs, separate triggers, separate audience. Nothing here can affect onboarding emails, and vice versa.